

OPTIMAL 8 — FIGHTER

The fighter's build. Weekdays at 3am, under an hour. Saturday 90 minutes. Sunday 70. Mobility at home. Nothing in the gym that doesn't make you a better fighter.

Your strength and conditioning for 16 weeks. Your coach owns boxing. This owns everything else: maximal strength, punching power, speed, the engine, and the tissue that keeps you training. Power is dosed three mornings a week, the engine is built twice, the squat gets a second exposure, the trunk is braced, the landmine appears twice. Boxing runs separately.

Week 1 began Monday 7 September. Switch to these pages from your next session — the week table is identical to the Singles version, so nothing restarts and no number changes.

Everything you need to run a session is written on that session's page. No codes, no cross-referencing, no jargon. If a word needed explaining, it's explained where it appears.

START HERE — HOW TO RUN THIS

The week. Seven sessions and a home block. Five at 3am before work — four real ones and an easy Friday — two on the weekend, and eight minutes of mobility at home every evening.

Day	When	Session	Time
Monday	3am	Upper strength + box-jump power dose	~57 min
Tuesday	3am	Jumps + engine session 1 + hands + trunk + calf	~56 min
Wednesday	3am	Sled, trap bar, pause squat, RDL, neck holds	~55 min
Thursday	3am	Throws + landmine, split squat, engine session 2, neck	~56 min

Friday	3am	Easy bike	~55 min
Saturday	morning	THE LEG & POWER SESSION	~90 min
Sunday	morning	Punch throws, fight rounds, core, Nordics	~70 min
Every day	evening, at home	Mobility (Friday: the full stretch)	8 min (Fri 20)

About 7¼ hours in the gym at peak, an hour and a quarter at home. Easy weeks: about 5½ in the gym.

What left, and why. The size blocks — lateral raises, rear-delt flies, shrugs, pulldowns, dips, curls — were 42 minutes a week that built the look, not the fighter. They're gone. The bench, push press, weighted chins, rows, trap bar and throws carry the shoulders, traps and arms from here. Mobility moved to the evening at home. Nothing else went: every sprint, jump, throw, lift, round and durability drill from the Singles version is still here, at the same numbers.

How to read a session page. Each page is a running order, numbered 1, 2, 3... with a clock time next to each step. Start at the top, work down, done. Every exercise shows: sets x reps · the weight · the rest between sets · a "How" line telling you exactly what to do.

How the weights work. Every barbell weight is a percentage of the most you can lift once (your "max").

You already know two: squat and bench. You find the other two in week 1: trap bar deadlift (Wednesday) and push press (Saturday). How: put light weight on, do 3 reps, add 10–20 kg, do 3 more. Keep going until 3 reps is hard but you had two more in you. Take that weight, add 8%, and that's your max. Example: hard triple at 150 kg → $150 \times 1.08 = 162$ kg.

Worked example all the way through this document: squat max 140 kg. Week 1 says squat 4 x 6 @ 75%. 75% of 140 = 105 kg. That's it. Round to the nearest 2.5 kg.

After a max-single week or test day, your new number becomes the max, and every percentage moves up with it.

THE FAST-BAR RULE — new, and it matters. A percentage of a number measured weeks ago goes stale fast when you're getting stronger quickly. So on the four main lifts — squat, bench, trap bar, push press — after your last work set, ask one question: *did the last rep move as fast as the first?* If yes, raise that lift's max by 2.5% before next week (squat and trap bar: round to the nearest 5 kg; bench and push press: 2.5 kg). Once per lift per week, no more. In the app, that's the max number in Settings. Max-

single weeks and test day replace the number outright. The grind rule still runs the other way: a grinding rep ends the set, and two grinding sets on one lift in a week means take 2.5% back off. If a lift hits the fast-bar rule three weeks running, expect the week-4 or week-9 max to come in well above 102% — take the second attempt.

Rests. Shorter than the Singles version on every strength lift: 2 minutes on the main lifts (2½ on the heavy triples in weeks 7–9 and on max days), 75–90 seconds on the accessories. Speed, jumps, sprints and throws keep their full rests — those are trained by quality, and a short rest turns them into conditioning. If a strength set feels flat after 2 minutes, take 2½. The number on the page is the default, not a stopwatch you fail.

Your engine number. Sunday of week 1 and Sunday of week 16 replace the fight rounds with a 20-minute bike test (written on the Sunday page). It gives you two things: the only measurement of the engine this program builds, and your peak heart rate — the number every easy ride is paced off.

Which week am I in? Count from your start Monday. The tables on the next page give you every number for every week. Weeks 5 and 10 are easy weeks (deloads). Weeks 15–16 wind down. Saturday of week 16 is test day.

The daily check — do this before every session. Ask four things: Is my resting heart rate up? Do I feel unusually sore? Flat and unmotivated? Sleep quality worse than normal for me?

- 0–1 yes = GREEN. Train as written.
- 2–3 yes = YELLOW. Take 7% off every barbell weight. Sprints become 3 runs at 90% effort, never flat out. Skip the last section of the session.
- Ill, injured, or 3 yellow days in a row = RED. No heavy lifts, no sprints, no jumps. Do the warm-up, the neck and shoulder work, then go home. Mobility at home as normal.

The head-contact rule. The morning after any sparring you do the LIGHT SESSION — Tuesday's warm-up, Thursday's neck block, Monday's shoulder circuit, about 30 minutes — or nothing. No heavy lifting, no sprinting, no jumping for 24 hours after head contact. The app swaps it in with one tap. Any headache, fogginess or light sensitivity: do nothing, and tell your coach.

The output rule. Every explosive set ends the moment the output drops — jump height, throw distance, bar speed. Rep counts are ceilings, not targets.

YOUR NUMBERS, WEEK BY WEEK

Squat and bench use the same sets and reps each week. "Max single" means work up to one top lift (there's a step-by-step ramp on the Saturday and Sunday pages).

Week	Squat (Sat) & bench (Mon)	Pause squat (Wed)	Trap bar (Wed)	Push press (Sat)
1	4 × 6 @ 75%	3 × 3 @ 75%	find your 3RM	find your 3RM
2	4 × 5 @ 78%	3 × 3 @ 78%	4 × 3 @ 80%	4 × 3 @ 82%
3	4 × 5 @ 80%	3 × 3 @ 80%	4 × 3 @ 80%	4 × 3 @ 82%
4	MAX SINGLE, then 2 × 3 @ 85%	—	4 × 3 @ 80%	— (squat max day; bench max is Sunday)
5	EASY WEEK · 2 × 5 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%
6	4 × 4 @ 82%	3 × 3 @ 80%	4 × 3 @ 85%	4 × 3 @ 85%
7	4 × 3 @ 85%	3 × 3 @ 82%	4 × 3 @ 85%	4 × 3 @ 85%
8	4 × 3 @ 87%	3 × 3 @ 84%	4 × 3 @ 85%	4 × 3 @ 85%
9	MAX SINGLE, then 2 × 2 @ 88%	—	3 × 2 @ 88%	— (squat max day; bench max is Sunday)
10	EASY WEEK · 2 × 4 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%	2 × 3 @ 65%
11–14	2 × 2 @ 88%, done fast	SPEED 3 × 3 @ 70%	3 × 3 @ 80%, fast	3 × 3 @ 80%, fast
15	2 × 2 @ 85%	2 × 2 @ 80%	2 × 2 @ 85%	2 × 2 @ 85%
16	1 × 2 @ 85% (bench 2 × 2)	—	1 × 2 @ 80%	—

Week	Sprints (Sat)	Jump circuit rounds (Sat)	Nordics (Sun)	Tuesday bike	Thursday bike	Fight sim rest (Sun)
1	3 × 20m	2	2 × 3	4-minute intervals	40- second repeats	bike test instead
2	4 × 20m	2	2 × 4	40-second repeats	30- second all-outs	90s, 3rd min flat out
3	5 × 20m	2	3 × 4	30-second all-outs	4-minute intervals	60s
4	5 × 20m	2	3 × 5	4-minute intervals	40- second repeats	60s — SCORED
5	3 × 20m @ 90%	1	2 × 3	20 min easy	20 min easy	skip
6	3 × 20m	3	3 × 5	4-minute intervals	40- second repeats	45s
7	4 × 20m	3	3 × 5	40-second repeats	30- second all-outs	90s, 3rd min flat out
8	5 × 20m	3	3 × 5	30-second all-outs	4-minute intervals	60s
9	5 × 20m	2	3 × 5	4-minute intervals	40- second repeats	60s — SCORED
10	3 × 20m @ 90%	1	2 × 3	20 min easy	20 min easy	skip
11	3 × 20m	4	3 × 5	4-minute intervals	40- second repeats	60s
12	4 × 20m	4	3 × 5	40-second repeats	30- second all-outs	45s

13	5 x 20m	4	3 x 5	30-second all-outs	4-minute intervals	60s
14	5 x 20m	4	3 x 5	4-minute intervals	40-second repeats	60s — SCORED
15	3 x 20m	2	2 x 4	30-second all-outs x 3	20 min easy	3 rounds only
16	3 x 20m (test day)	1	—	15 min easy	—	bike test instead

Sled runs (Wednesday): 5 a week. Week 1: 4. Easy weeks: 3.

Two extras that change by block: weeks 11–14, the drop jumps become depth jumps, the jump circuit moves to the front of Saturday's session (written on the Saturday page), and Wednesday's pause squat becomes a speed squat.

TRAINING ALONE — NON-NEGOTIABLE

- **Squat:** safety pins in the rack, set just below your lowest position, on every set over 80%. No pins in the gym = no max singles; stop at a heavy 3.
- **Bench:** pins at chest height, and never clamp collars on the bar — if you get stuck you tip the plates off. Bench max singles only happen on Sundays, fresh, first thing.
- **Trap bar at 3am:** the one heavy lift allowed at that hour. Nothing passes over your body, and a rep you're not sure of gets set down, not fought.
- **Nordics:** heels anchored under something solid. Stop the set the moment your lower back rounds.
- **Drop jumps:** rubber hex dumbbells, drop them straight down, land on clear floor.
- If you are not certain you'll make the rep, you don't start it.

MONDAY • 3AM • UPPER BODY STRENGTH + POWER DOSE •
~57 min

Upper strength and the first of the week's three power doses. Nothing is taken to failure.

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 8 min

Lie on your back, feet up on a bench, knees at right angles. 5 slow breaths: in through the nose for 4 seconds, out for 8.

Band pull-aparts × 20 — hold a light band in front of you at shoulder height, arms straight, pull it out until it touches your chest, control it back.

Band external rotations × 15 per arm — elbow pinned to your ribs, bent 90°, hand rotates outward against the band.

Wall slides × 10 — back flat on a wall, forearms on the wall like a goalpost, slide them up and down without them leaving the wall.

Bench warm-up sets: bar × 10, 40% × 5, 60% × 3, 75% × 2. Rest about a minute between.

2 • 0:08 — BENCH THROW • 5 sets of 3 (week 16: 3 sets of 3) • start ~1/3 of bench max • rest 2 min • 11 min

How: on a Smith machine, bar light. Lower to your chest, then press so hard the bar leaves your hands at the top. Catch it, reset, repeat. The right weight is whatever flies highest — adjust until it does.

Stop the set the instant a throw is visibly lower than the last.

No Smith machine? Throw a 4–6 kg medicine ball off your chest at a wall, 5 × 5, as hard as you can.

This is your punch-speed lift. In weeks 11–14 it merges into the circuit below.

3 • 0:19 — POWER DOSE • BOX JUMPS • 3 sets of 3 • rest 60–90s • 5 min

How: a box at knee-to-hip height. Quick dip, jump as high as you can, land soft on top, step down. Three perfect jumps, never three tired ones.

Explosiveness responds to how often the nervous system is asked, not how much. Five minutes, three mornings a week.

4 • 0:24 — BENCH PRESS • sets, reps and % from the week table • rest 2 min (weeks 7–9: 2½) • 10 min

How: pins at chest height, no collars. Controlled down, drive up hard. If a rep grinds, that set is over. Last set: fast-bar rule — last rep as fast as the first, add 2.5% to your bench max for next week.

Weeks 11–14 only, steps 2 and 4 merge into one circuit, 4 rounds: 2 bench reps @ 85% → rest 20s → 3 bench throws → rest 20s → 3 clap push-ups → rest 2½ min. Heavy wakes the system up; fast uses it.

5 • 0:34 — WEIGHTED CHIN-UPS • 3 sets of 5 • rest 90s • 6 min

How: wide grip, palms away (switch to a neutral grip if wide ever bothers your shoulders), weight on a belt or a dumbbell between your feet. Start from a dead hang, pull chin over the bar, lower under control, no swinging. Add weight when all three sets are clean.

Pulling strength protects the shoulders that throw a thousand punches a week.

6 • 0:40 — CHEST-SUPPORTED ROW • 4 sets of 8 (easy weeks 3) • rest 75s • 7 min

How: lie chest-down on an incline bench with dumbbells. Row until your elbows pass your body, pause one second at the top, lower slow.

Four sets so your pulling matches your pressing. A boxer's shoulders live or die on that balance.

7 • 0:47 — SHOULDER CIRCUIT + BAND CATCH • 2 rounds • 8 min

Round = the four moves back to back, then rest 45s:

Side-lying external rotation × 12 per side — lie on your side, top elbow glued to your ribs, rotate a light dumbbell from your belly up toward the ceiling.

Prone T raise × 10 — lie face down on an incline bench, arms hanging; raise them out to a T shape, thumbs up.

Face pulls × 15 — rope on a high cable, pull it to your face with elbows high, squeeze the back of the shoulders.

Wall slides × 10 — same as the warm-up.

Then BAND DECELERATION CATCH • 2 sets of 8 per arm: hold a light band anchored behind you. Punch the arm out fast; the band snatches it back — brake it hard and stop it dead in the last third of the return. Fast out, hard stop.

Every right hand you throw, this muscle group has to brake your arm. This is the only place it gets trained to.

Done • ~0:55–0:57. Mobility: at home tonight (the home block is on its own page).

TUESDAY • 3AM • JUMPS • ENGINE 1 • HANDS • TRUNK • CALF

• ~56 min

Power dose first, fresh, then the first of the week's two engine sessions. Your legs had yesterday off.

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 6 min

3 easy minutes on the bike → band pull-aparts × 20 → goblet squats × 8 (hold a dumbbell at your chest, squat) → push-ups × 10 → 90/90 hip switches × 5 each way (sit with one leg bent in front of you, one bent behind, both at right angles; swivel the knees over to the other side without using your hands) → pogo hops × 20 (bounce on the balls of your feet, legs almost straight, quick off the floor).

2 • 0:06 — POWER DOSE • JUMPS • 8 min • rest 90s

Broad jumps, 3 × 2 — two-foot jump forward for distance, stick the landing dead still.

Trap bar jumps, 3 × 3 — stand inside a trap bar loaded to 20% of your trap bar max (week 1: empty bar), jump with it, land soft.

The second of three weekly power doses. Fresh legs, before the bike — never after.

3 • 0:14 — BIKE SESSION • 24 min • check the week table — Tuesday's column

Bike or SkiErg — pick one and keep it all 16 weeks so your numbers compare. Write down your output.

4-minute intervals: 4 rounds of 4 minutes HARD (breathing heavily, could speak 2–3 words at most) with 3 easy minutes between. The single best session there is for building your engine.

40-second repeats: 40 seconds absolutely flat out, 80 seconds easy. Do 3, rest 5 full minutes, do 3 more. Rounds 1–2 feel fine, round 3 burns, the last three are horrible. That burning is the point — it's what the late rounds of a fight feel like, and this is the only session that goes there. Don't hold back early to survive the end.

30-second all-outs: 30 seconds at absolute maximum, then 3 FULL minutes of complete rest. 5 rounds. Take every second of the rest — cutting it short turns it into a different (wrong) session.

Easy: 20 minutes at a pace where you could chat. That's it.

4 • 0:38 — HANDS • 5 min

Knuckle hold, 3 × 20 seconds — push-up position on your fists on a mat, wrist dead straight so forearm and knuckles make one line. Hold. Move to a firmer surface over the weeks only if your wrist stays straight.

Band wrist extension, 2 × 15 — forearm on your knee, palm down, band in the hand; lift the knuckles up toward you.

The most common boxing injury is a wrist folding under impact. Five minutes of insurance. Your job covers your grip — no grip work in here.

5 • 0:43 — TRUNK • 9 min • rest 45s between exercises

Pallof press, 3 × 10 per side — band at chest height, anchored beside you. Press your hands straight out and hold 2 seconds without letting it twist you. Anti-rotation: your trunk is what turns leg drive into hand speed, and it has to be stiff to transmit it.

Ab wheel rollouts, 3 × 8–12 — knees down, roll the wheel out only as far as your lower back stays flat, pull back.

Copenhagen plank, 2 × 30 seconds per side — side plank with your top foot up on a bench, bottom leg lifted off the floor. Hold. Groin strength — the muscles you pivot off.

6 • 0:52 — SEATED CALF RAISE • 3 sets of 15 • rest 60s • 4 min

How: seated machine, or a barbell padded across your knees. Up on the balls of the feet, pause, down slow. It must be seated (knee bent) — that's the muscle that keeps you on your toes in round six; the jumps and sprints already cover the other calf muscle. Moved here from Saturday — a low-cost lift that fits a low-cost slot.

Done • ~0:56. Mobility at home tonight.

WEDNESDAY • 3AM • SLED • TRAP BAR • PAUSE SQUAT • RDL • NECK HOLDS • ~55 min

The heavy lower morning. Sled first while the nervous system is freshest, then the pulls, then the second squat exposure. Nothing to failure. The hamstring work that leaves you sore is on Sunday, not here. Sparred last night? This becomes the light session, and the heavy work waits a week.

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 6 min — Tuesday's warm-up, then trap bar warm-up sets (bar × 5, 50% × 3, 65% × 2) and squat warm-up sets (40% × 3, 60% × 2).

2 • 0:06 — HEAVY SLED SPRINTS • 5 runs (week 1: 4; easy weeks 3) • rest 2½–3 min • 16 min

How: load the sled with 40–60% of your bodyweight (32–48 kg at 80 kg). Lean into it at about 45°, and sprint 20 metres driving the ground backwards through your whole foot.

Get the load right by the clock: each 20m run should take 5–7 seconds. Faster — add weight. Slower — take some off.

This is forward pressure — your fighting style with resistance on it. First in the session, before the lifts, while the nervous system is freshest.

3 • 0:22 — TRAP BAR DEADLIFT • sets, reps and % from the week table • rest 2 min (weeks 7–9: 2½) • 12 min

How: stand inside the bar, grip the handles, flat back, drive the floor away FAST. No grinding, no slow reps — set the bar down and end the set if speed drops. Week 1: no percentages yet — this is where you find your 3RM (the ramp is on the Start Here page). Hard triple $\times 1.08$ = your max. Last set: fast-bar rule.

At 3am this is the one heavy lift allowed: nothing passes over your body, and a rep that isn't there gets set down, not fought.

4 • 0:34 — PAUSE SQUAT • sets, reps and % from the week table • rest 2 min • PINS SET • 10 min

How: bar on your back, sit to just below parallel and hold there, dead still, for a full two seconds — then drive up hard. Pins set.

Weeks 11–14 the pause goes and it becomes a SPEED SQUAT: 3 $\times$ 3 @ 70%, every rep as fast as you can move it. Skipped on max-single weeks (4, 9) and in week 16.

This is the second squat exposure — submaximal, paused, from the position rear-leg drive starts in. Saturday owns the heavy squat; this is at a weight you own.

5 • 0:44 — ROMANIAN DEADLIFT • 3 $\times$ 6 • rest 75s • 6 min

How: bar at your hips, soft knees, push your hips back until the bar reaches mid-shin with a flat back, stand back up by driving the hips through. Load: start around 60% of your trap bar max and add 2.5–5 kg a week while every rep still moves at the same speed.

Hamstring strength without the soreness. The eccentric work that does leave you sore — the Nordics — is last on Sunday, with two leg-free days behind it.

6 • 0:50 — NECK • HOLDS ONLY • 5 min — the 4-direction holds from Thursday: press your palm hard against your forehead and push your head into it, the head never moves, 3 $\times$ 10 seconds; then hand on the back of the head, then each side. Second dose of the week; Thursday carries the full block.

Done • ~0:55. Mobility at home tonight.

THURSDAY • 3AM • THROWS + LANDMINE • SPLIT SQUAT • ENGINE 2 • NECK • ~56 min

The third power dose, the only single-leg lift, the second engine session and the full neck block. (Week 16: warm-up and neck only.)

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 6 min — same as Tuesday.

2 • 0:06 — POWER DOSE • THROWS + LANDMINE • 8 min • 45s between sets

Rotational shot-put, 2 × 3 per side — medicine ball, 3–5 kg, at the shoulder, side-on to the wall, drive off the back hip. Flat and hard, like the punch.

Landmine punch, 2 × 5 per side — one end of a barbell in a corner or landmine sleeve, the other end at your shoulder, in your stance. Drive the hips and punch it up and away — never press it. Bar speed is the metric; add weight only when it still snaps.

The third weekly power dose: the unloaded ballistic and the loaded punch pattern, three days before Sunday's full session.

3 • 0:14 — SPLIT SQUAT, REAR FOOT ELEVATED • 3 sets of 6–8 each leg (easy weeks and weeks 15–16: 2 sets) • rest 75s • 8 min

How: back foot up on a bench behind you, front foot far enough forward that your shin stays near vertical, a dumbbell in each hand. Sink straight down until the back knee nearly touches the floor, drive up through the front heel. Weak side first, and the same weight on both legs — the weaker leg sets the load. Start at a weight you could do 10 with; add when 8 is clean.

Every other loaded leg lift in the week is on two legs. Boxing isn't — the rear-leg drive and the pivot are one foot, and two-legged lifting lets your strong side hide the weak one. This is where the weak side gets found and fixed. Moved here from Saturday: 24 hours after the heavy lower morning, 48 before Saturday's sprints, and before the bike so the reps are clean.

4 • 0:22 — BIKE SESSION • 24 min • check the week table — Thursday's column

The same four session types as Tuesday (written on the Tuesday page). Thursday always runs a different quality from Tuesday, so each quality is trained twice every three weeks. Same bike, same rules, write down your output.

5 • 0:46 — NECK • 10 min

4-direction holds, 3 × 10 seconds each direction — press your palm hard against your forehead and push your head into it; the head never moves. Then hand on the back of

the head, then each side.

Rapid tense, 3 × 6 per direction — with a band resting light pressure on your head, snap from fully relaxed to fully braced in under a second, hold 2 seconds, relax.

Perturbation hold, 3 × 20 seconds — band around your head, anchored to the rack. Brace your neck in neutral and tug the band in small random pulses with your own hand, from different angles. The head does not move.

Catch, 2 × 6 per direction — let the band start to pull your head toward the anchor, then stop it dead in the last third.

Straight truth: a stronger, stiffer neck measurably reduces how much your head accelerates when hit. Whether that prevents concussion is not proven. Cheap bet, sound mechanism — and it is not armour: it changes nothing about what you take in sparring.

Done • ~0:56. Mobility at home tonight.

FRIDAY • 3AM • EASY BIKE • ~55 min

Tomorrow is the biggest session of the week. Today's only job is arriving there fresh with the engine fed. Nothing hard, nothing heavy, nothing fast.

1 • 0:00 — EASY BIKE • 55 min (weeks 6–10: 45 • week 16: 30)

Steady spin at a pace where you could hold a conversation, breathing through your nose. If you can't speak a full sentence, slow down. Roughly 65–75% of the peak heart rate from your 20-minute test. No warm-up needed — ride into it. Fine on an empty stomach. Bike, not running — running beats your legs up before tomorrow.

Boring on purpose. The aerobic base under two interval sessions and the fight rounds — and it keeps tomorrow's legs fresh by being easy.

Tonight, at home: THE FULL STRETCH • 20 min — written on the home page. It replaces the 8-minute mobility on Fridays.

SATURDAY • MORNING • THE LEG & POWER SESSION • ~90 min

(Week 16: skip this page — Saturday of week 16 is TEST DAY, two pages on.)

No shift, fed and fresh. This is the session that matters most all week, on the one day nothing can compromise it. Fuel it like the fuel plan's big day: porridge 6:30, shake 7:45, start 8:15. Ninety minutes now instead of two hours — the size work is gone, the split squat and calf raise have weekday slots, and every sprint, jump, squat, round and push press is exactly as it was.

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 12 min

90/90 hip switches × 5 each way.

Hip airplanes × 5 per side — stand on one leg holding the rack, hinge your chest to horizontal, then rotate your chest toward the floor and then up toward the ceiling.

Cossack squats × 6 per side — feet very wide, sit all the way down over one leg, other leg straight with the heel down, back up.

Leg swings × 10 each — hold the rack, swing one leg forward-and-back, then side-to-side.

Pogo hops 2 × 20 — bounce on the balls of your feet, legs almost straight, quick off the floor like a skipping rope without the rope.

Sprint build-ups — never skip these: one 20m run at 60% effort, one at 75%, one at 90%.

Squat warm-up sets: 40% × 3, 60% × 2, 75% × 1.

2 • 0:12 — FLYING SPRINTS • runs from the week table • rest 2½–3 min between runs • 14 min

How: jog-build for 10–15m, then 20 metres absolutely flat out. Walk back, full rest — this is a speed session, not cardio. Time them if you can.

Treadmill options, best first: curved self-powered → outdoors → treadmill on an 8–12% incline at 12–15 km/h for 8–10 seconds, safety clip on.

Sprinting flat-out is the single most explosive thing you can do, and regular top-speed running is also the best protection your hamstrings can get. On a yellow day: 3 runs at 90%, never max.

3 • 0:26 — LOADED DROP JUMPS • 4 sets of 4 • rest 2 min • 12 min

How: hold a hex dumbbell in each hand, 8–12 kg each. Dip fast into a quarter squat — at the bottom, let both dumbbells go — and jump straight up as high as you can, empty-handed. Land soft on clear floor, step away from the dumbbells, reset.

Stop the set the moment a jump is lower than the last.

Weeks 11–14 instead: DEPTH JUMPS, 4 × 5 — step off a 30–40 cm box, and the instant your feet touch, jump as high as you can. Shortest possible time on the floor.

4 • 0:38 — SIDE BOUNDS • 3 sets of 4 per side • rest 90s • 7 min

How: stand on one leg, jump sideways as far as you can, land on the other leg and stick the landing dead still for 2 seconds. Weeks 11–14: no stick — bounce straight back the other way.

The sideways push-off is how you cut the ring off. Nothing else in the week trains it.

5 • 0:45 — BACK SQUAT • sets, reps and % from the week table • rest 2½ min (weeks 7–9: 3) • PINS SET • 15 min

How: bar on your back, break at the hips and knees together, sit to just below parallel, drive up hard. Every rep fast on the way up; a grinding rep ends the set. Last set: fast-bar rule — last rep as fast as the first, add 2.5% to your squat max for next week.

MAX SINGLE — weeks 4 and 9 only (about 20 min). Instead of the normal sets: after your warm-up sets, go 50% × 5 → 65% × 3 → 75% × 2 → 85% × 1 → 92% × 1 → then ONE attempt at 100–102% of your current max. A second attempt only if the first flew up, or if the fast-bar rule has been firing for three weeks. Pins set, no exceptions. Then do the back-off sets from the table at 85% of the NEW number. Write the new max down — every weight for the next month comes off it.

6 • 1:00 — THE JUMP CIRCUIT • rounds from the week table • 18 min (weeks 11–14: 22)

One round =

1. Back squat, 2 reps @ 85% (weeks 11–14: 88%) — wakes the nervous system up
2. rest 20 seconds
3. Box jumps × 3 — jump onto a knee-to-hip-height box, land soft, step down
4. rest 20 seconds
5. Trap bar jumps × 3 — stand inside a trap bar loaded to 20% of your trap bar max (week 1: empty bar), jump with it, land soft
6. rest 20 seconds
7. Weeks 11–14 only: band-assisted jumps × 3 — loop a heavy band over the top of the rack, tuck it under your armpits so it pulls you upward, and jump — it makes you faster than you are

Rest 2½–3 minutes, go again. End the round the moment jump height drops. If round 2

jumps as high as round 1, the rest can be a bit shorter; if it doesn't, it was too short.

Weeks 11–14: this circuit moves to the FRONT — do it as step 5, before the squat, while you're freshest. The squat (2 × 2 @ 88%) becomes step 6.

7 • 1:18 — PUSH PRESS • sets, reps and % from the week table • rest 2 min • 10 min

How: bar on the front of your shoulders. Quick shallow knee dip, then drive the bar overhead with your LEGS and punch it to lockout. Down under control. Week 1: find your 3RM here, same ramp method as the trap bar. Last set: fast-bar rule. Weeks 4 and 9: skip the push press — the squat max is enough maximal work for one day; the bench max is Sunday morning, first thing.

Legs → braced trunk → hands. The same route a punch takes, and the heaviest thing your shoulders and traps see all week — which is why the traps and shoulders don't need a size block.

Done • ~1:28 (weeks 4 and 9: ~1:25 • weeks 11–14: ~1:32). Mobility at home tonight.

SUNDAY • MORNING • PUNCH THROWS • FIGHT ROUNDS • CORE • NORDICS • ~70 min

Second free morning. Punches, rounds, core and hands, and the week's hamstring work last, with two leg-free days behind it. No pressing today on purpose so Monday's bench gets 42 hours. Same fuelling as Saturday. (Week 16: the warm-up, the 20-minute test and the weekly check. Nothing else. Stretch at home.)

1 • 0:00 — WARM-UP • 10 min — Tuesday's warm-up, plus: broad jumps 3 × 2 • medicine-ball chest passes 3 × 3 as hard as you can • 3 × 10-second bike sprints with a minute between • then three EASY practice throws of each of the four throws below.

Weeks 4 and 9 only — the BENCH MAX SINGLE comes first, straight after the warm-up (adds ~12 min). Bench warm-up sets: bar × 10, 40% × 5, 60% × 3. Then the ramp: 50% × 5 → 65% × 3 → 75% × 2 → 85% × 1 → 92% × 1 → one attempt at 100–102% of your current max. Pins at chest height, no collars. Write the new max down.

2 • 0:10 — THE FOUR PUNCH THROWS • rounds from the week table (3, or 4 in weeks 11–14; 2 in weeks 15–16) • 16 min

Medicine ball, 3–5 kg. If it isn't flying, it's too heavy. Both sides equally. 45 seconds between exercises, 90 seconds between rounds.

One round =

Rotational shot-put × 4 per side — your straight right. Ball at your shoulder, boxing stance side-on to a wall. Drive off the back hip and put the ball into the wall as hard as you can, flat and hard like a punch. A few from a lower crouch for the body-shot version.

Downward diagonal throw × 4 per side — your overhand right. Ball high outside your shoulder. Drive it down and across your body, letting go toward the opposite hip. Back foot pivots, trunk turns AND side-bends, exactly like the punch.

Hook throw × 4 per side — your lead hook. Ball held at chest height in bent arms. Pivot hard off the lead leg and sling it sideways into the wall.

Landmine punch × 5 per side — your loaded straight. One end of a barbell in a corner or landmine sleeve, the other end at your shoulder, in your stance. Drive the hips and PUNCH it up and away — never a slow press. Catch it, go again.

Straight punches are built on forward drive; hooks on rotation. They're different physical problems, so all four get trained.

3 • 0:26 — FIGHT SIMULATION • 6 rounds × 3 minutes • rest from the week table • 24 min

Each round: minute 1 on the SkiErg → minute 2 on the assault bike → minute 3 landmine punches (odd rounds) or medicine-ball slams (even rounds). If your gym has a bag, minute 3 is bag work — hard and technically clean.

Rule 1 — relaxed jaw, shoulders down. Finish a round with your traps by your ears and that round doesn't count, whatever the number says.

Rule 2 — nose-breathe through rounds 1–3 as a pacing tool, not a test. Mouth open whenever you need it; the round still counts.

On SCORED weeks (4, 9, 14): write down round 1's output and round 6's output. Round 6 ÷ round 1 is your fade — the whole game is getting it toward 100%.

Three-minute rounds, never enough rest, holding output across six — nothing else you own trains the actual shape of a fight.

Weeks 1 and 16 — THE 20-MINUTE BIKE TEST instead of the fight rounds: 5 easy minutes, then 20 minutes for the most distance you can, on the same bike or SkiErg every time. No pacing plan — go and find out. Write down two numbers: the distance, and the highest heart rate you saw. That peak is your practical maximum; from now on every easy ride sits around 65–75% of it. Week 1 is the baseline; week 16 is the verdict.

4 • 0:50 — CORE + HANDS • rest 60s • 8 min

Hanging leg raises, 3 × 8–12 — hang from a bar, dumbbell between your feet if needed,

lift legs to hip height or above, no swinging.

Side plank reach-through, 2 × 10 per side — in a side plank, thread your top arm under your body, then rotate open to the ceiling.

Hands: knuckle hold 3 × 20s and band wrist extension 2 × 15 (as Tuesday).

5 • 0:58 — NORDIC CURLS • sets and reps from the week table • rest 2 min • 8 min

How: kneel with your heels anchored under something solid (or a partner-less setup: loaded bar over the ankles). Keeping your body straight from knees to head, lower yourself forward as SLOWLY as you can, catch yourself with your hands, push back up. Stop the set the moment your lower back rounds — not at the rep count.

Last block of the last day, on purpose: the hardest hamstring work of the week, followed by two leg-free days, so the soreness is gone before it can cost you a sprint. Strong hamstrings on the way down is the best-proven injury protection in all of sport; the reps ramp up over the first month — follow the table. (Week 16: skip.)

6 • 1:06 — WEEKLY CHECK • 2 min • write these down

Bodyweight • resting heart rate • how many green / yellow / red days • any joint that's complaining (hips, shoulders, wrists 0–10) • how many boxing nights your hands felt slow • energy 1–10 • how many evenings you did the home block.

Two slow-hands nights, or three yellows in one week = next week is an easy week, whatever the plan says. Every 4–6 weeks: tape — arms, shoulders, waist.

Done • ~1:08 (weeks 4 and 9: ~1:20). Mobility at home tonight.

THE HOME BLOCK • EVERY EVENING • 8 min (FRIDAY 20)

This is the mobility that used to close every gym session. It moved home so the gym time is all training. It does the same job at 8pm that it did at 4am; the only thing that changes is whether you do it. Kit: a foam roller, a light band, and something to hold at your chest — a kettlebell, a dumbbell, a bag of sugar.

The four moves, every evening:

Foam roller across your mid-back, hands behind head, arch back over it × 8, moving the roller up a notch each time.

Open book × 6 per side — lie on your side, knees bent, arms together out front; open the top arm to the far side, chest follows, knees stay down. Hold 3 seconds.

90/90 hip switches × 5 each way — sit with one leg bent in front of you, one bent behind, both at right angles; swivel the knees over to the other side without using your hands.

Deep squat hold, 90 seconds — hold a weight at your chest and sit in the very bottom of a squat.

Friday evening: THE FULL STRETCH · 20 min (replaces the four moves)

Upper back first, always: foam roller arch-backs × 8 → open book × 8 per side → thread the needle × 8 per side (on all fours, slide one arm under the other, shoulder toward the floor) → on all fours, hand behind head, rotate the elbow to the ceiling × 8 per side.

Hips: 90/90 switches × 5 each with a 30-second hold per side → couch stretch 90s per side (back foot up on the sofa behind you, knee down on a cushion, squeeze the glute, stand tall) → frog 90s (knees wide on the floor, rock the hips back) → deep squat hold with a weight, 90s.

Shoulders: hang from a bar or doorframe pull-up bar 45s (skip if you haven't one) → wall slides × 12 → band pull-aparts × 20 → band external rotations × 15 per arm.

If you skip it: nothing shows this week. By week 6 the hips tighten, squat depth goes, the sprints get shorter and the pause squat starts to hurt. The weekly check asks how many evenings you did it, so you'll see it coming.

TEST DAY — SATURDAY OF WEEK 16

Fresh after two easy weeks. These are your real numbers, and every percentage for the next 16 weeks comes off them. Most explosive first, full recovery between everything.

1. **Flying 20m sprint** — 3 attempts, best time. Alone: phone on a tripod side-on at the 20m zone, slow-mo, count frames between the two marks (at 240fps, 240 frames = 1 second). Or a cheap laser timing gate — the only piece of kit worth buying for this.
2. **Depth jump** — 3 attempts, best rebound height. Film it in slow-mo, take the flight time (feet off to feet on) in seconds: height in cm $\approx 123 \times \text{flight time}^2$. A 0.5-second flight is about 31 cm.
3. **Diagonal throw** — 3 per side, best distance.
4. **Shot-put throw** — 3 per side, best distance.
5. **Back squat** — true max single, pins set. Ramp as on the Saturday page.
6. **Bench press** — true max single, pins, no collars.

7. **Trap bar** — heavy 3RM ($\times 1.08 = \text{new max}$).
8. **Tape and bodyweight** — arm, shoulders, waist.
9. **Sunday** — the 20-minute bike test in place of the fight rounds (Sunday page).
Distance and peak heart rate.

Targets each 16 weeks: lifts +3–6% · throws and jump +3–5% · sprint 1–3% faster · 20-minute distance +3–5% · fight-sim fade 1–3 points better. If the fast-bar rule fired most weeks, the lifts will beat that range — the targets are floors, not ceilings. Then 3–4 easy days, and week 1 starts again off the new numbers.

FUEL

The fuel plan does not change. The 3:10 shake before every hard morning, Monday to Thursday. Friday's ride is fasted, and Friday's 5pm carb feed loads Saturday; Tuesday's 5pm feed loads Wednesday's trap bar. Saturday and Sunday eat like the fuel plan's big day: porridge 6:30, shake 7:45, session 8:15, the big feed within the hour after you finish — Saturday finishes around 9:45 now, so the shake follows the session, not the clock.

Total training time is about an hour and three-quarters a week lower than the Singles version. Do not cut calories on that assumption. The tape decides — waist flat and arms and shoulders up means the food is right; waist climbing faster than the arms means take 100–150 off the 3pm shake on the lightest days. Creatine 5 g every day. Omega-3 daily. Vitamin D through the winter.

WHAT YOUR COACH OWNS

1. **Hitting hard on contact** — the split-second stiffening of fist, arm and trunk at impact that makes two men with the same squat punch differently. Built on the bag, with attention on the moment of contact.
 2. **Snap and retraction** — pads, where the feedback is instant.
 3. **Keeping your guard up when gassed** — only shows up when someone's trying to hit you.
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THE THINKING (read at home, not in the gym)

What this version is. Optimal 8 Singles with the aesthetics taken out, the mobility taken home, the weekday sessions capped under an hour, the weekend sessions cut to what the fighter needs, shorter strength rests, and one new rule. Everything that makes you hit harder, move faster, last longer or stay in one piece is unchanged and at the same numbers.

What went, and what it cost. Three size blocks — 42 minutes a week — that never touched the fighter. Chest and triceps still get bench, bench throws and the weeks 11–14 clap circuit; shoulders and traps get push press, trap bar and chins; arms get chins and rows. Cost to the fighter: nothing. Cost to the look: some direct arm and shoulder volume, which the compound lifts cover well enough that the tape, not the mirror, will tell you.

What moved, and why there. The split squat left Saturday for Thursday: 24 hours after the heavy lower morning, 48 hours before Saturday's sprints, and before the bike so the reps stay clean. The seated calf raise left Saturday for the end of Tuesday: a low-cost lift in a low-cost slot. Mobility left every session for the evening — it does the same job at 8pm, and the eight minutes it freed are what keep four weekday sessions under an hour. The warm-ups did not move: they are what makes sprinting, jumping and lifting at 3am survivable, and they are not mobility.

Why the rests are shorter. Recovery is not the limit in this build; time is. Two minutes between strength sets is enough for triples and fives at these percentages, and 75–90 seconds is enough for rows and split squats. Speed, jumps, sprints and throws keep every second of their rest, because the moment those get tired they stop training what they're for.

Why the fast-bar rule exists. Percentages are a way of prescribing effort from a number, and the number is only as good as the day it was measured. When strength moves faster than the max weeks can catch it, every set between max weeks is lighter than intended, and the grind rule can only ever take weight off. The fast-bar rule is the other half: one question after the last set, one number moved 2.5%, once a week at most. It keeps the loading honest between measurements.

Placement, unchanged. The two sessions that decide this program — legs and power, and punches and rounds — sit on the weekend, fed, fresh, no shift after them. Wednesday is the heavy lower morning, 72 hours from Saturday. Friday is easy so Saturday isn't. The Nordics go last on Sunday with two leg-free days behind them. Saturday is 90 minutes now, not 120, and gives up nothing the fighter uses: sprints, reactive jumps, side bounds, heavy squat, the full jump circuit and the push press are all there, all fresh, in the same order.

The evidence, unchanged. Leg strength drives punch force (Loturco 2016; Dunn

2022). Throw speed drives punch speed. The engine is mostly aerobic, with brutal spikes — easy volume, 4-minute intervals (Helgerud 2007), 40-second repeats for the late-round burn, and the fight sim for the actual shape of a fight. Durability is cheap and targeted: neck, hands, Nordics, Copenhagen planks, cuff work.

Stop the set when it slows. Speed of movement is the quality being trained; grinding reps train grinding. Rep ranges are ceilings, not targets.

That's the science. The gym pages above are the program. From here, the numbers do the talking.